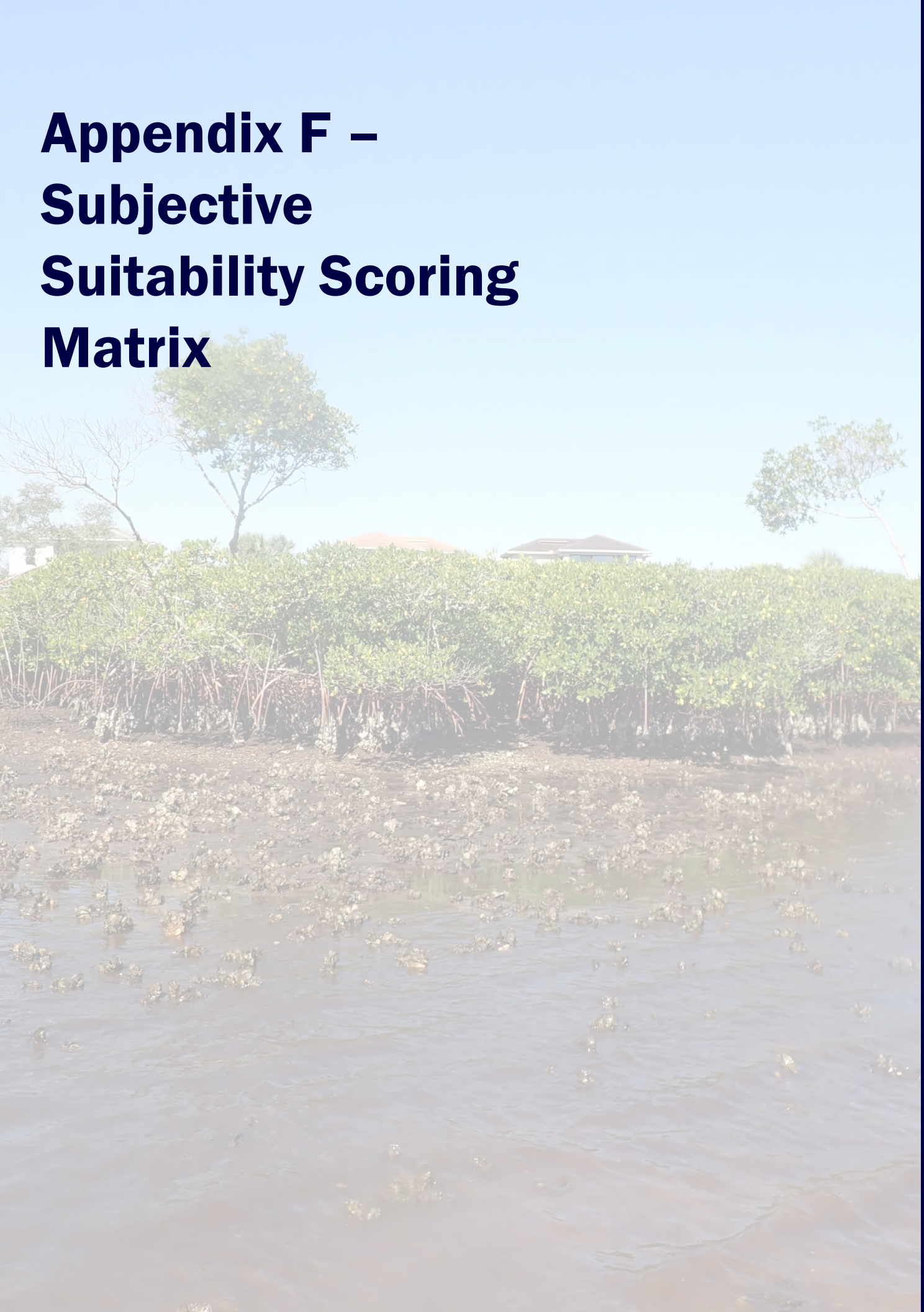
Appendix F – Subjective Suitability Scoring Matrix



Subjective Scoring Matrix

Manatee County Oyster Restoration Master Plan

Subjective analysis and scoring was done by Damon Moore in March of 2024 based on past observations in the Manatee River in the context of large-scale oyster habitat restoration potential. Scoring is subjective based on large-scale oyster restoration project suitability; 1 = highest suitability, 5 = lowest suitability.

Most points have corresponding general area polygons to which the scoring of each point also applies.

Total Score:	
1	Likely suitable
2	
3	Likely has potential
4	
5+	Likely not suitable
	No site data; likely high potential

Point ID	Subjective Score	Lat	Long	Positive Attributes	Negative Attributes	Potential for:
SA-1	3	27.533077°	-82.635360°	Freshwater input from the north.	Limited in size potential due to heavy seagrass presence.	Small scale volunteer project.
SA-2	2	27.532067°	-82.644603°	A Living shoreline project would be good for this area.	Not good for large-scale oyster restoration but would support some as part of a LSL project in the intertidal zone.	Living shoreline project.
SA-3	2	27.524982°	-82.640843°	Public access on public lands.	Oyster recruitment limited to intertidal and interstitial rock areas only. High energy shoreline.	Living shoreline project in cooperation with National Park Service.
SA-4	5	27.521049°	-82.641956°	Public access on public lands. Freshwater input nearby.	Public uses (especially with dogs) will likely prevent a project here.	Very low project potential.
SA-5	5	27.530981°	-82.646836°	Not much positive here for oysters.	Low oyster cover on nearby reef balls. Assumed high predator pressures due to high salinity.	Very low project potential.
SA-6	5	27.532640°	-82.636219°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-7	5	27.532552°	-82.641511°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-8	5	27.531025°	-82.630769°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-9	5	27.528241°	-82.625103°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-10	5	27.524171°	-82.622209°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-11	4	27.530729°	-82.627854°	A Living shoreline project would be good for this area.	Not good for large-scale oyster restoration but would support some as part of a LSL project in the intertidal zone.	Living shoreline project.
SA-12	5	27.519779°	-82.635950°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-13	2	27.519746°	-82.633529°	A Living shoreline project would be good for this area.	Not good for large-scale oyster restoration but would support some as part of a LSL project in the intertidal zone.	Living shoreline project.
SA-14	5	27.528839°	-82.630298°	Not much positive here for oysters.	Low oyster cover on nearby wreck. Assumed high predator pressures due to high salinity.	Very low project potential.
SA-15	2	27.509403°	-82.616787°	A Living shoreline project would be good for this area.	Not good for large-scale oyster restoration but would support some as part of a LSL project in the intertidal zone.	Living shoreline project.
SA-16	3	27.510120°	-82.620785°	On-bottom intertidal reef nearby. Sediments firm. Seagrass presence would increase permitting complexity.	Very sparse seagrass cover. Potential for navigation concerns by neighbors.	Volunteer based project potential.
SA-17	2	27.495854°	-82.578285°	Adjacent to existing scattered intertidal oyster bar. Highly visible location.	Area is not large. Land access would be challenging unless property owner to the west was supportive.	Volunteer based project potential.
SA-18	5	27.514541°	-82.619817°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-19	5	27.517628°	-82.631788°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-20	5	27.513567°	-82.625792°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-21	5	27.523117°	-82.610123°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-22	5	27.519562°	-82.605353°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-23	5	27.512965°	-82.607882°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-24	5	27.516480°	-82.618683°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-25	4	27.522153°	-82.623181°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines. Possible subtidal projects. Less seagrass cover but not absent.	Moderate seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Some project potential. Pilot project recommended before large scale.
SA-26	4	27.508496°	-82.613955°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines. Possible subtidal projects. Less seagrass cover but not absent.	Moderate seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures. Multiple adjacent land owners	Some project potential. Pilot project recommended before large scale.
SA-27	4	27.505150°	-82.605647°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines. Possible subtidal projects. Less seagrass cover but not absent.	Moderate seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures. Multiple adjacent land owners	Some project potential. Pilot project recommended before large scale.
SA-28	5	27.515279°	-82.604545°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines.	High seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures.	Very low project potential.
SA-29	4	27.518555°	-82.598053°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines. Possible subtidal projects. Less seagrass cover but not absent.	Moderate seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures. Multiple adjacent land owners	Some project potential. Pilot project recommended before large scale.
SA-30	4	27.513816°	-82.591292°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines. Possible subtidal projects. Less seagrass cover but not absent.	Moderate seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures. Multiple adjacent land owners	Some project potential. Pilot project recommended before large scale.
SA-31	4	27.503189°	-82.591573°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines. Possible subtidal projects. Less seagrass cover but not absent.	Moderate seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures. Multiple adjacent land owners	Some project potential. Pilot project recommended before large scale.
SA-32	4	27.511251°	-82.581549°	Potential for intertidal projects along shorelines. Possible subtidal projects. Less seagrass cover but not absent.	Moderate seagrass coverages and assumed high salinity and associated predator pressures. Multiple adjacent land owners	Some project potential. Pilot project recommended before large scale.
SA-33	3	27.511667°	-82.576642°	Highly visible location.	Area is not large. Land access would be challenging unless property owner to the north was supportive.	Volunteer based project potential.
SA-34	2	27.499528°	-82.575496°	Adjacent to public owned lands. Highly visible location.	Area is not large. Land access would be challenging unless property owner to the north was supportive.	Volunteer based project potential.
SA-35	5	27.497156°	-82.579730°	Freshwater input from the south.	Very deep mucks make up the sediments.	No project potential due to sediment composition.
SA-36	5	27.499214°	-82.554387°	No positive attributes.	Very deep mucks make up the sediments. Directly adjacent to City of Bradenton wastewater discharge. History of spills.	No project potential due to sediment composition.
SA-37	1	27.517310°	-82.506543°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline.	Scattered seagrass	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-38	1	27.505428°	-82.522799°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline. Known high levels of natural recruitment and rapid growth from pilot projects. See YouTube video at https://youtu.be/L2KNew6U4rI?si=RSH3iNP0eEeVSVR2	Scattered seagrass	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-39	2	27.499072°	-82.551507°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Large public land owner (City of Bradenton) adjacent shoreline. Observed oyster recruitment on shoreline projects.	Scattered seagrass. Potential for macroalgae deposition in some areas. Refer to Manatee County 2021 & 2022 aerial images.	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects with largescale volunteer projects
SA-40	1	27.501587°	-82.530036°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline.	Scattered seagrass	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-41	2	27.508033°	-82.514655°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Multiple adjacent land owners but separated by channel.	Scattered seagrass	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-42	2	27.511416°	-82.509360°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Multiple adjacent land owners but separated by channel.	Scattered seagrass	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-43	1	27.524227°	-82.501153°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline & far enough offshore to avoid riparian rights issues.	Scattered seagrass. Less than ideal sediments in some areas. Very firm sediments on shoal.	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-44	1	27.527408°	-82.490775°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline & far enough offshore to avoid riparian rights issues.	Scattered seagrass. Less than ideal sediments in some areas. Very firm sediments on shoal.	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-45	1	27.522506°	-82.491593°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline.	Scattered seagrass	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-46	1	27.521432°	-82.487611°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline.	Scattered seagrass	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-47	1	27.518128°	-82.489854°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline.	Scattered seagrass	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-48	1	27.500183°	-82.525718°	Desirable sediment conditions. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline.	Scattered seagrass	Potential for large seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects with rookery island protection added benefits.
SA-49	1	27.524723°	-82.484778°	Desirable sediment conditions in some areas. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline. Potential for FDACS Restoration Aquaculture Lease Area	Scattered seagrass. Less than ideal sediments in some areas.	Potential for large oyster project areas and FDACS Restoration aquaculture lease areas.
SA-50	1	27.521905°	-82.480784°	Desirable sediment conditions in some areas. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline. Potential for FDACS Restoration Aquaculture Lease Area	Scattered seagrass. Less than ideal sediments in some areas.	Potential for large oyster project areas and FDACS Restoration aquaculture lease areas.
SA-51	3	27.518910°	-82.482665°	Desirable sediment conditions in some areas but very poor in others. Very low seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Potential for FDACS Restoration Aquaculture Lease Area	Scattered seagrass. Less than ideal sediments in some areas.	Potential for large oyster project areas and FDACS Restoration aquaculture lease areas.
SA-52	5	27.511843°	-82.491754°	Healthy oysters on adjacent shorelines.	Deep mucky sediments where creek empties into river.	Very low project potential.
SA-53	5	27.524553°	-82.429910°	Limited small oysters on rocks by boat ramp	Salinities likely too low for sustained oyster growth.	Very low project potential.
SA-54	5	27.524553°	-82.429910°	Only low density barnacles on mangrove roots. No oysters observed.	Salinities likely too low for sustained oyster growth.	Very low project potential.
SA-55	5	27.518347°	-82.441400°	Very low density oysters on submerged stumps in this area. Mussels were doing well.	Salinities likely too low for sustained oyster growth.	Very low oyster project potential. Introduction of cultch would likely lead to heavy growth of mussels.
SA-56	3	27.517985°	-82.447916°	Healthy oysters on adjacent mangroves. Very good sediment conditions on bar.	Boat traffic to the west.	Potential for this area and shallow water areas to
SA-57	4	27.527310°	-82.462630°	Healthy oysters on adjacent mangroves. Good sediments. Oyster growth observed on previous pilot project in this exact location, but not nearly as robust as the Carlton Arms Site. YouTube video shows growth of oysters after 15 months at this location. https://youtu.be/hQhg7ocitxo?si=v1hZpKeIUcpN8IDC	Oyster growth is not as robust as seen in other areas further downstream. Near navigation channel and Historical Recreation Areas for watersports (See Manatee County Boaters Guide).	Low project potential due to adjacent navigation channel and potential for recreational users conflict.

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2	
3	Likely has potential
4	
5+	Likely not suitable
	No site data; likely high potential

Point ID	Subjective Score	Lat	Long	Positive Attributes	Negative Attributes	Potential for:
SA-58	5	27.453300°	-82.492832°	Only low density barnacles on mangrove roots. No oysters observed.	Salinities likely too low for sustained oyster growth.	Very low project potential.
SA-59	5	27.531731°	-82.455441°	Only low density barnacles on mangrove roots. No oysters observed.	Salinities likely too low for sustained oyster growth.	Very low project potential.
SA-60	5	27.529982°	-82.476424°	Only low density barnacles on mangrove roots. Very few oysters observed.	Salinities likely too low for sustained oyster growth.	Very low project potential.
SA-61	5	27.523056°	-82.449520°	Very few oysters on riprap at pond outfall.	Salinities likely too low for sustained oyster growth.	Very low project potential.
SA-62	4	27.520611°	-82.450989°	Oysters on adjacent mangrove roots.	Near navigation channel and Historical Recreation Areas for watersports (See Manatee County Boaters Guide).	Low project potential.
SA-63	4	27.494017°	-82.520291°	Sediments desirable, very low to nearly non-existent seagrass cover. High quality subtidal oyster reefs nearby. Nearby boat ramp for easy access.	Submerged lands appear to be privately owned as part of the parcel that contains the north end of Pine Island.	Good project potential with acquisition.
SA-64	3	27.495462°	-82.525281°	High quality subtidal oyster reefs nearby. Very low seagrass Cover Nearby boat ramp for easy access.	Boat ramp and navigation channel nearby may lead to user impacts.	Potential for smaller volunteer based project.
SA-65	5	27.495427°	-82.516229°	High quality subtidal oyster reefs nearby. Very low seagrass Cover Nearby boat ramp for easy access.	Boat ramp and navigation channel nearby may lead to user impacts.	Potential for smaller volunteer based project.
SA-66	3	27.519993°	-82.461028°	Very low to nearly absent seagrass cover. Consistent recruitment of oysters on adjacent mangroves.	Oysters not as robust as seen in other areas. Position within river and shallow waters on approach could create logistical challenges for restoration projects.	Potential for smaller projects.
SA-67	5	27.519063°	-82.475695°	Very low to nearly absent seagrass cover. Consistent recruitment of oysters on adjacent mangroves. Nearby subtidal reefs. Generally good sediments.		Very high project potential. FDACS lease area potential.
SA-68	4	27.523727°	-82.473591°	Very low to nearly absent seagrass cover. Consistent recruitment of oysters on adjacent mangroves. Nearby subtidal reefs.	Sediments softer than ideal in some areas. Some observed sedimentation of oysters on mangrove adjacent reefs to the east.	High project potential. FDACS lease area potential.
SA-69	3	27.522337°	-82.466422°	Very low to nearly absent seagrass cover. Consistent recruitment of oysters on adjacent mangroves.	Position within river and shallow waters on approach could create logistical challenges for restoration projects.	High project potential.
SA-70	1	27.517735°	-82.479882°	Very low to nearly absent seagrass cover. Consistent recruitment of oysters on adjacent mangroves. Nearby subtidal reefs. Generally good sediments. Single adjacent upland property owner. Highly unlikely for riparian rights issues.		Very high project potential.
SA-71	1	27.524741°	-82.477106°	Very low to nearly absent seagrass cover. Consistent recruitment of oysters on adjacent mangroves. Nearby subtidal reefs. Very desirable sediments. Single adjacent upland property owner. Highly unlikely for riparian rights issues.		Very high project potential.
SA-72	4	27.516532°	-82.524506°	Desirable sediment conditions. Scattered seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline.	Scattered seagrass. Potential for future dock by property owner/riparian rights concerns.	Potential for seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-73	4	27.516287°	-82.527251°	Desirable sediment conditions. Scattered seagrass cover. Nearby subtidal oyster reefs. Large single-owner adjacent shoreline.	Scattered seagrass. Potential for future dock by property owner/riparian rights concerns.	Potential for seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-74	3	27.518127°	-82.515926°	Generally desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Generally low seagrass coverages.	Numerous adjacent property owners, docks, channels.	Potential for small individual projects with cooperation from adjacent landowners.
SA-75	3	27.528844°	-82.499971°	Generally desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Generally low seagrass coverages.	Numerous adjacent property owners, docks, channels.	Potential for small individual projects with cooperation from adjacent landowners.
SA-76	5	27.530063°	-82.490036°	Generally desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Very low seagrass to nearly absent. Single adjacent property owner (Community Group)		Potential for volunteer land-based project with cooperation from Colony Cove.
SA-77	3	27.513814°	-82.533284°	Generally desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Generally low seagrass coverages.	Numerous adjacent property owners, docks, channels.	Potential for small individual projects with cooperation from adjacent landowners.
SA-78	2	27.509169°	-82.561437°	Generally desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Generally low seagrass coverages. Land accessible for volunteer projects.	Scattered seagrass growth. Subtidal oysters likely to received increased predatory pressure to relatively higher salinities.	Potential for largescale volunteer projects and intertidal bars.
SA-79	2	27.508132°	-82.563787°	Generally desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Generally low seagrass coverages. Land accessible for volunteer projects.	Scattered seagrass growth. Subtidal oysters likely to received increased predatory pressure to relatively higher salinities.	Potential for largescale volunteer projects and intertidal bars.
SA-80	3	27.511476°	-82.564609°	Generally desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Generally low seagrass coverages. Adjacent landowner is public entity.	Scattered seagrass growth. Subtidal oysters likely to received increased predatory pressure to relatively higher salinities.	Potential for largescale volunteer projects and intertidal bars.
SA-81	3	27.511649°	-82.565434°	Generally desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Generally low seagrass coverages.	Scattered seagrass growth. Subtidal oysters likely to received increased predatory pressure to relatively higher salinities.	Potential for smaller project in coordination with community to the north.
SA-82	3	27.512349°	-82.567910°	Generally desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Generally low seagrass coverages.	Scattered seagrass growth. Subtidal oysters likely to received increased predatory pressure to relatively higher salinities.	Potential for smaller project in coordination with community to the north.
SA-83	4	27.510551°	-82.547723°	Observed oyster growth on subtidal hard surfaces both artificial and natural hardbottom.	Softer sediments than ideal. Existing exposed hardbottom in areas with mix of oysters, mussels and occasional live sponge. Relatively higher seagrass coverages.	Generally lower project potential with exception of isolated areas.
SA-84	3	27.511144°	-82.548711°	Observed oyster growth on subtidal hard surfaces both artificial and natural hardbottom. Single adjacent property owner. Scattered seagrass occurrence.	Sediments generally acceptable but not ideal in all locations.	Potential for seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-85	3	27.511282°	-82.540229°	Observed oyster growth on subtidal hard surfaces both artificial and natural hardbottom. Single adjacent property owner. Scattered seagrass occurrence.	Sediments generally acceptable but not ideal in all locations.	Potential for seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-86	2	27.504937°	-82.535030°	Observed oyster growth on subtidal hard surfaces both artificial and natural hardbottom. Far enough offshore to avoid riparian rights issues. Very desirable sediment conditions.	Slightly higher seagrass occurrences. Possible boater conflicts due to location.	Potential for seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-87	2	27.502532°	-82.543362°	Observed oyster growth on subtidal hard surfaces both artificial and natural hardbottom. Far enough offshore to avoid riparian rights issues. Likely desirable sediment conditions.	Slightly higher seagrass occurrences.	Potential for seagrass-oyster co-restoration projects.
SA-88	2	27.510490°	-82.572459°	Desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Generally low seagrass coverages. Adjacent property owner is public entity.	Scattered seagrass growth. Subtidal oysters likely to received increased predatory pressure to relatively higher salinities.	Volunteer based project potential for shoreline intertidal bars.
SA-89	3	27.511944°	-82.570886°	Generally desirable sediment and observed oyster growth conditions. Generally low seagrass coverages.	Scattered seagrass growth. Subtidal oysters likely to received increased predatory pressure to relatively higher salinities.	Potential for project in coordination with property owners to the north.
SA-90	N/A	27.484549°	-82.517816°	High potential. Needs site survey.	High potential. Needs site survey.	High potential. Needs site survey.
SA-91	N/A	27.496470°	-82.519287°	High potential. Needs site survey.	High potential. Needs site survey.	High potential. Needs site survey.